

RESEARCH PROPOSAL

STANDARDISATION OF DIGITAL FORENSIC PROTOCOLS AND ESTABLISHING RELIABILITY METRICS FOR LEGAL REPORTS

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Programme: [Programme Name]
Course: [Course Code and Course Name]
Lecturer: [Lecturer Name]
Semester: [Semester]
Submission Date: [Date]

Abstract

Write a concise summary of the entire review article. Write a concise summary of the entire review article. Write a concise summary of the entire review article. Write a concise summary of the entire review article.

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The abstract should include:

- Background/context of the selected research topic
- Purpose of the review
- General approach used to select and analyse the research articles
- Major findings from the reviewed literature
- Key research gaps identified
- Overall conclusion

Recommended length: 150–250 words.

Keywords: Keyword 1; Keyword 2; Keyword 3; Keyword 4; Keyword 5

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Chapter 1

Introduction

1.1 Background

Introduce the selected research topic and explain why it is important.

This is how you add inline references in the document given that all your references have been copied in the references.bib. Recent studies have demonstrated the effectiveness of artificial intelligence techniques (Smith & Kumar, 2024).

Follow this example to include more than one references. Several studies have investigated these approaches (Ahmad & Rahman, 2022; Lee & Tan, 2023; Smith & Kumar, 2024).

Discuss:

- What is the research topic?
- What problem does it address?
- Why is the problem important?
- Where is the topic currently being applied?
- Why is there a need to study/review this topic?

Students should support important statements with appropriate research references.

Chapter 2

Literature Review (Recap)

Clearly describe the problem or issue that motivates this literature review.

Explain:

- What is currently known?
- What problems exist?
- What limitations exist in current approaches?
- Why is a review of existing research necessary?

Chapter 3

Problem Statement

State the objectives of the review article.

For example:

1. To review existing research related to [topic].
2. To compare the approaches used by different researchers.
3. To analyse the findings and limitations of existing studies.
4. To identify research gaps and potential future research directions.

Chapter 4

Research Questions

Develop 2–4 research questions that guide the review.

For Example:

RQ1: What approaches have been used to address [research problem]?

RQ2: What are the major findings reported in existing studies?

RQ3: What are the limitations of the existing approaches?

RQ4: What research gaps and future opportunities can be identified?

Chapter 5

Review Methodology

Explain how the group conducted the literature review.

5.1 Literature Search Strategy

Describe:

- Databases/search engines used
- Search keywords
- Search strings
- Publication period
- Type of publications considered

Example databases:

- Scopus
- Web of Science
- IEEE Xplore
- ScienceDirect
- SpringerLink
- ACM Digital Library
- Google Scholar

5.2 Inclusion and Exclusion Criteria

Describe the criteria used to determine which research articles were included in or excluded from the review.

Inclusion criteria may include:

- Articles directly related to the selected research topic
- Peer-reviewed research articles
- Articles published within the selected publication period
- Articles indexed in the selected academic databases
- Articles available in full text

Exclusion criteria may include:

- Articles outside the scope of the research topic
- Duplicate publications
- Non-peer-reviewed publications
- Articles outside the selected publication period
- Articles without sufficient methodological or research information

Table 5.1: Inclusion and exclusion criteria used for the literature review

Criteria	Inclusion	Exclusion
Publication type	Peer-reviewed research articles	Non-peer-reviewed articles
Publication period	[e.g., 2021–2026]	Articles outside selected period
Language	English	Other languages
Topic	Directly related to selected topic	Not directly related
Full text	Full-text available	Full text unavailable

This is a sample table. Tables should be placed in the main text near to the first time they are cited, with the caption on top and left aligned. The font of the table caption is size 9 and the content in the table is size 10.

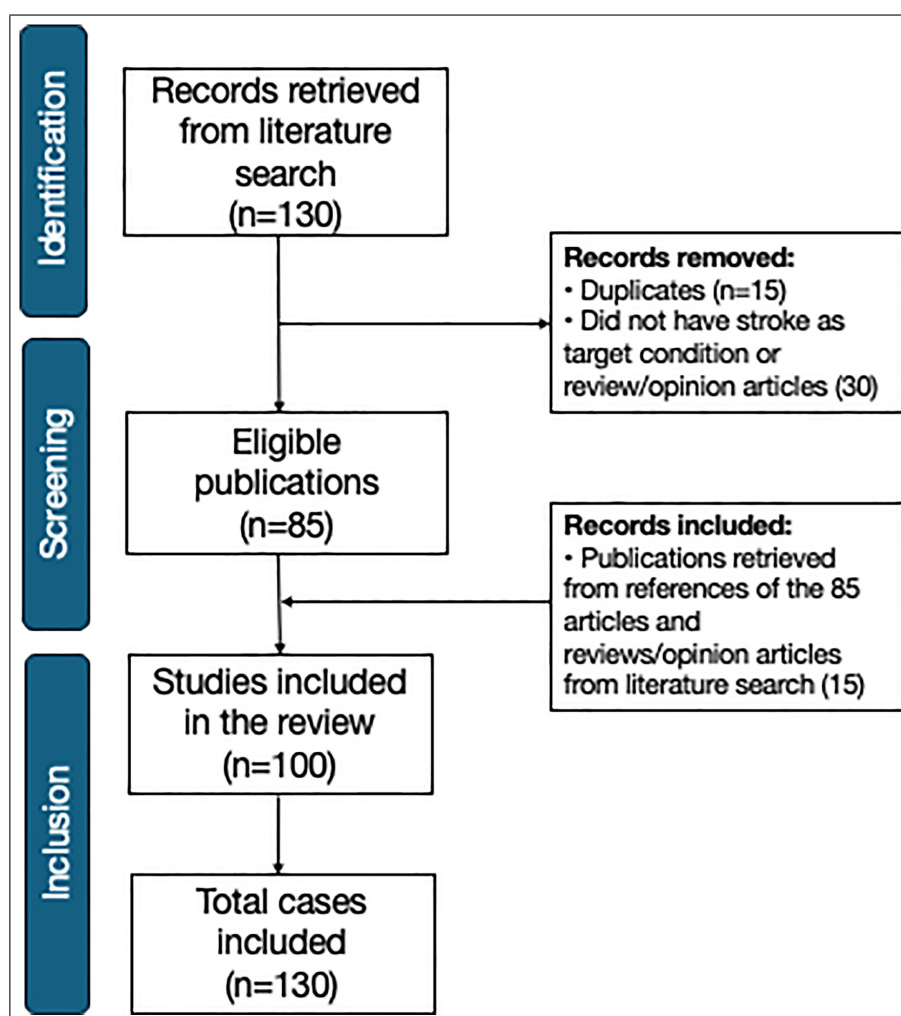


Figure 5.1: PRISMA flow diagram of the study selection process.

This is a figure. All figures should be centred with figure caption following the sequence Figure 1, Figure 2, and so on. The caption should also be centred. The caption for figures should be size 9.

5.3 Article Selection

Each student must review **at least 3 research articles**.

Therefore:

- Minimum articles per student = 3
- Minimum articles per group = 12

The group may use more than 12 articles if necessary.
Explain how the final articles were selected for the review.

Chapter 6

Expected Outcomes

Provide an overall critical discussion of the literature.

The discussion should answer:

- What has the research community achieved so far?
- Which approaches are most promising?
- What are the major challenges?
- Are the current approaches sufficient?
- What limitations remain?
- How has the research area evolved?
- What important issues remain unresolved?

This section should demonstrate **critical thinking**, not merely summarisation.

Chapter 7

Project Timeline

Provide an overall critical discussion of the literature.

The discussion should answer:

- What has the research community achieved so far?
- Which approaches are most promising?
- What are the major challenges?
- Are the current approaches sufficient?
- What limitations remain?
- How has the research area evolved?
- What important issues remain unresolved?

This section should demonstrate **critical thinking**, not merely summarisation.

Chapter 8

Conclusion

Summarise the major findings of the review.

The conclusion should:

- Restate the purpose of the review
- Summarise the major findings
- Highlight important research gaps
- State the overall conclusion
- Briefly indicate future research opportunities

Do not introduce completely new information or references in the conclusion.

References

- Ahmad, N., & Rahman, F. (2022). Deep learning methods for intelligent systems. *Proceedings of the International Conference on Artificial Intelligence*, 120–126.
- Lee, M., & Tan, W. (2023). A comprehensive review of machine learning techniques. *Expert Systems with Applications*, 215, 119234. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.eswa.2023.119234>
- Smith, J. A., & Kumar, R. (2024). Advanced research approaches in artificial intelligence. *IEEE Access*, 12, 12345–12356. <https://doi.org/10.1109/ACCESS.2024.1234567>